

Posterity - Project Context

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What Is Posterity

A social media legacy app that allows users to schedule messages, memories, and content to be delivered to loved ones after death. A digital time capsule with a subscription model. Posterity posts content on behalf of customers to their social media accounts after plan activation.

Core Values

Compassion over convenience Content delivery begins January 1 of the year following plan activation — not immediately after the non-response trigger fires. The bereaved deserve time to grieve before receiving scheduled content. Posterity prioritizes emotional readiness over technical immediacy.

Life chapters, not dates Most services think in calendar dates. Posterity thinks in life chapters. A plan's year counter does not start when a customer signs up — it starts when their legacy begins for others. A customer who signs up in 2026 and whose plan enters abeyance in 2034 gets a full Year 1 starting January 1 2035. Plans are organized by years of plan, not calendar dates. Two timelines are tracked: payment timeline and delivery timeline.

Trust through transparency No employee ever touches customer funds directly. All financial movements are automated with full audit trails. Customers can trust that their legacy investment is protected.

Accessibility without compromise Financial hardship options ensure everyone can leave something behind regardless of means. A legacy should not be a luxury.

Control until the end Customers can build, test, preview, and adjust their legacy content at any time before activation. Nothing is set in stone until they are ready.

Subscription Tiers (LOCKED June 2026)

Tier	Price	Messages	Video
Horizon	\$9.99/year	None	None
Basic	\$99/year	4 per year (quarterly)	1 per year
Premium	\$249/year	12 per year (monthly)	4 per year
Legacy	\$899/year	52 per year (weekly)	12 per year
Custom	Contact Us	Custom	Custom
Grace	Contact Us	1-2 messages	None

All message tiers include optional handwritten note per message. Videos weighted at 2x a text message unit (operational cost rationale — do NOT display on pricing cards, include in user manual only). Plan names on site/customer-facing materials: Horizon, Basic, Premium, Legacy, Custom, Grace. Plan names in Stripe only: Posterity Horizon, Posterity Basic, Posterity Premium, Posterity Legacy, Posterity Grace.

Plan Lifecycle & Phases

Posterity plans move through four distinct phases. This language appears throughout the product, the onboarding walkthrough, and all customer-facing materials. It is a core part of what makes Posterity unique — clinical or death-related terminology is removed entirely. The system responds only to events and dates, never to death itself.

Key Terms:

- **Initiated** — a plan that has been paid for and exists in the system
- **Non-response trigger** (*internal term only*) — the system event that moves a plan into Abeyance. Occurs when check-in goes unanswered after all 6 notifications, or when trusted contact submits confirmation. The system responds only to events — never to death itself.
- **Abeyance** — the intentional waiting period between the non-response trigger and plan activation. Content is ready but not yet delivered. The bereaved are given time to process their loss.
- **Active** — the plan is delivering content according to the customer's calendar

The Four Phases:

Phase 1 — Horizon (Building Phase) The customer has subscribed to Horizon at \$9.99/year. They are actively building their legacy — uploading content, setting up their calendar, and selecting the plan tiers they intend to initiate. Multiple plans can be built and worked on simultaneously via a side menu in the dashboard. There is no time limit on this phase. The Horizon subscription covers storage for as long as the customer remains in this phase.

Phase 2 — Planning Phase (Post-Initiation) The customer has paid for their plan(s). The plan is now initiated — it exists, it is funded, and content continues to be refined. The customer continues their regular 6-month check-ins. This is typically the longest phase — it lasts however long the customer lives after initiating their plan, potentially years or decades. The Horizon subscription transitions into the initiated plan at this point.

Phase 3 — Abeyance The non-response trigger has fired — either the check-in system detected a non-response after all 6 notifications, or a trusted contact submitted a confirmation through their portal. The plan is now in a waiting state. No content is delivered during this phase. This is intentionally brief — at most a few months between the trigger and January 1. This grace period reflects one of Posterity's core values: the bereaved deserve time to process before a loved one's legacy begins arriving.

Phase 4 — Active Phase January 1 has arrived. Content delivery begins according to the customer's calendar. The system automatically generates that year's delivery schedule and posts content on the dates the customer set. This phase repeats annually for each plan year initiated.

Plan Year System

- Plans counted in years (Year 1, Year 2, Year 3) not calendar dates
- Year 1 begins January 1 of the calendar year following plan entering Abeyance
- Payment timeline and delivery timeline tracked separately
- Storage fees (Horizon) cover gap between signup and initiation
- Customers can pay for multiple years upfront
- All plans in Horizon account automatically included in cart at initiation
- Calendar in user profiles built around real calendar dates tied to plan years
- Funds for Year 2 not accessed until Year 1 is complete
- Year-by-year fund release automated via server-side cron job
- Service limit: 5 years guaranteed from Horizon signup, unlimited years optional (best effort, no legal guarantee beyond 5)
- Needs further discussion with lawyer before building anything dependent on long-term service obligations

Horizon Tier

- \$9.99/year is a holding fee not a service fee

- Dual purpose:
 1. Inactive account storage — holds content and account data during years between active plan years when no delivery is scheduled
 2. Building phase — customer builds legacy content before initiating any plan
- Content stored but not delivered until plan enters Active Phase
- Recurring annual subscription
- Horizon subscription transitions into initiated plan upon payment
- Customers can upload content anytime during Horizon phase
- Customers can create and work on multiple plans simultaneously during Horizon

Horizon Lapse Grace Period

If Horizon payment lapses:

- Via Twilio SMS: 2 notifications/month for months 1-3 (6 total)
- Via Twilio SMS: 2 notifications in final half month
- Via Twilio SMS: 1 final notification that account was deleted
- Total grace period: approximately 3.5 months before deletion

Calendar System

- Plan Year 1 begins January 1 of the calendar year following plan entering Abeyance
- Intentional grace period: gives bereaved time to process loss before receiving content
- Uses real calendar dates — no relative day counting
- Customers set real dates during calendar setup (anniversaries, birthdays, custom dates)
- System auto-generates annual delivery schedule every January 1
- Leap years handled automatically by real calendar
- When plan enters Active Phase, system takes most recent iteration of customer's calendar
- Each calendar entry = Supabase record: plan year, delivery date, content attached, delivery status
- Daily automated check triggers delivery when date matches
- Full automation possible with this model

Check-in System (Planning Phase)

- User confirms they are present every 6 months via email or SMS
- Missed check-in triggers 3-month warning period:
 - Via Twilio SMS + email: 2 notifications/month for 3 months (6 total)
 - Notifications sent to BOTH customer AND trusted contact
- No response after all 6 notifications: non-response trigger fires, plan moves into Abeyance
- This applies to Planning Phase customers only (separate from Horizon lapse system)

Trusted Contact System

- Optional but strongly encouraged
- Customer adds trusted contact name and email in user profile during setup
- System automatically sends trusted contact an invitation to create their own Posterity portal account
- Customer can see confirmation that trusted contact has accepted and set up their account
- Trusted contact portal is a separate login on the Posterity site, completely independent from customer account
- Trusted contact portal shows: their role, linked customer, notification history, confirmation button
- Trusted contact receives all 6 check-in notifications alongside customer during Planning Phase
- When trusted contact believes customer has passed: they log into their portal and submit confirmation

- Confirmation requires double verification (re-enter password + confirmation code sent to their email/phone) to prevent accidental triggering
- Once confirmed: non-response trigger fires, plan moves into Abeyance
- Trusted contact payment authority: TBD, tabled for later discussion
- Trusted Contact page added to global nav dropdown for easy portal access

Social Media Integration

- Platforms: Facebook and Instagram to start, gauge interest and expand later
- Meta Business API required for all scheduled posts
- Backup login credentials REQUIRED
- Individual unique passwords automatically generated by Posterity for each customer, stored securely in Supabase
- Customers are responsible for activating and maintaining their backup credentials prior to plan activation. Failure to provide credentials is a breach of user agreement but will not cancel service.
- 2FA must be configured using Posterity-controlled backup email or Twilio phone number to ensure access post plan activation
- Buffer used by Posterity team post plan activation to post content to customer social media accounts. Direct platform login used as fallback.
- Posterity team posts on behalf of customers during Active Phase
- Facebook Memories feature: skipped for now, add later if needed (requires direct login)
- Monitor Meta API announcements as standing operational task
- Meta API risks:
 - Meta reduced Instagram limits 96% in 2025 without warning
 - Video: 10 calls/second cap vs 300 for text
 - Instagram caps API posts at 100 per 24-hour rolling window
 - Mitigation: backup direct login, manual override essential

Video & Content Delivery

- Delivered via social media, text (MMS via Twilio), and email
- Hard limit: 25MB maximum, 720p minimum quality, 3-4 minutes maximum length
- FFmpeg.wasm compresses automatically client-side at moment of upload within user profile
- System rejects upload with clear error message if file exceeds 25MB after compression
- Via Twilio MMS: video delivery for files under 25MB
- Secure link fallback via Twilio SMS if MMS carrier delivery fails
- Contract and user profile disclaimer: "If direct video delivery is not possible due to carrier limitations, a secure link to your video will be shared instead"
- Email video delivery via link, not attachment (Phase 5)
- Unused video slots can be used as message slots (flexible rollover)
- Remaining messages/videos ticker in user profiles
- Ability to process multiple posts simultaneously (Phase 5)
- Manual override "Post Manually" button for API failures (Phase 5)

Video Storage & Compression

- Storage via Supabase Storage (low cost at early scale)
- Client-side compression via FFmpeg.wasm at point of upload in user profile (Phase 4)
- Per-video limits: 25MB max, 720p min, 3-4 minutes max (enforced at upload)
- Total Supabase storage allocation per tier TBD at scale
- Upgrade path: Cloudflare Stream or Mux at scale

- Video weight explanation (2x units) goes in user manual only, not pricing cards

Customer Contact & Communication

- Via Twilio: dedicated Posterity phone number with voicemail enabled
- Via Twilio: inbound customer contact for Build Your Own inquiries, general questions, Grace tier applications
- Via Twilio: outbound automated SMS notifications to customers (check-ins, alerts, delivery confirmations)
- Via Twilio: secure video link delivery fallback if MMS carrier delivery fails
- No intermediary at launch, founder handles directly
- Posterity email account (Phase 5) — used for video delivery via link and responding to customer email inquiries

Financial Architecture

- Customer pre-loads full balance upfront
- Funds held in Posterity Trust Account (internal name) / Posterity Legacy Fund (customer-facing name)
- Annual transfers from Trust Account to Posterity Operating Account triggered by server-side cron job at start of each plan year
- Mercury Bank recommended: free business checking, API access, sub-accounts, built for startups
- Mercury Bank two-account setup chosen as intentional workaround to avoid legal ramifications from regional escrow ordinances while achieving the same functional result as formal escrow
- No employee ever accesses funds directly — fully automated with audit logs
- Any automation failure triggers immediate admin dashboard alert: what failed, which customer, amount, timestamp, retry status
- Full audit trail for every transfer: timestamp, amount, customer ID, plan year
- Formal escrow deferred to Phase 6 — lawyer review required before Phase 5 financial build begins
- Stripe fees: ~2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction — not material at early scale

User Profiles (Phase 4)

- Calendar setup — customers set real dates (anniversaries, birthdays, custom dates) that feed the automation system
- Social media connection (Meta API + unique Posterity-generated backup credentials — required). 2FA configured using Posterity-controlled contact details.
- Video/photo/message upload with FFmpeg compression
- Total cost calculation
- Payment setup (pre-loaded balance)
- Trusted contact setup — enter name and email, system sends invitation, customer confirms acceptance
- Check-in preferences — preferred notification method (email or SMS) and trusted contact details for check-in alerts
- Remaining messages/videos ticker
- Assurance that money not withdrawn until plan enters Active Phase
- Multi-plan side menu — customers can create and work on multiple plans simultaneously
- All plans in Horizon account automatically included in cart at initiation
- All automated and set up to notify Posterity team

Onboarding & Walkthrough (Phase 4)

- Step-by-step onboarding walkthrough
- Explain the four plan phases (Horizon, Planning, Abeyance, Active) during onboarding
- Phase language displayed in user profile dashboard so customers always know which phase their plan is in
- AI chatbot for customer setup guidance and product explanations

- Test/preview mode so customers can see exactly what recipients will receive
- Encourage customers to double-check and test everything before finalizing
- Explain video storage and posting has higher workload (2x unit weight) — in walkthrough/manual only

Build Your Own & Financial Hardship (Grace)

- Manual input panel in admin dashboard for custom posting parameters
- Automated system treats them like regular accounts once parameters are set
- How they fit year-by-year automation: needs further discussion before building
- Contact Us buttons on pricing page (no Stripe product needed)

Admin & Operations (Phase 5)

- Operational dashboard: all tasks in priority order
- Financial dashboard: completely separate from operational
- No employee access to customer funds — audit logs only
- Automated year-by-year fund release via server-side cron job (Mercury Bank)
- Admin dashboard alerts for any automation failures
- Manual input panel for Build Your Own and Grace accounts
- Manual override Post Manually button for API failures
- Ability to process multiple posts simultaneously
- Via Twilio: voicemail notifications
- Test account option post-launch
- Standing task: monitor Meta API announcements

Financials & Fixed Costs

Monthly fixed costs at early scale:

- Vercel: \$20
- Supabase Pro: \$25
- Buffer: \$15
- Twilio: \$10
- Meta API/Dev tools: \$10
- Misc: \$20
- Total: \$100/month = \$1,200/year

Labour assumptions (for pricing review):

- Employee rate: \$20/hour
- Text post: 5 mins = \$1.67 labour
- Video post: 15 mins = \$5.00 labour
- Social media login time not yet factored in — revisit at pricing review

Break-even (solo, cover \$1,200/year fixed costs):

- Basic: 13 customers
- Premium: 5 customers
- Legacy: 2 customers

Break-even (with part-time hire, \$7,200/year total):

- Basic: 73 customers
- Premium: 29 customers
- Legacy: 9 customers

Realistic mixed target: 25-35 customers covers all costs including part-time hire (12-18 month target)

Full pricing analysis: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1nnJhh0fyng8HbgPDchzJMzb5v-MCqJE/view?usp=sharing>

Legal & Compliance

- Formal Terms of Service before launch (lawyer review)
- Copyright application
- Liability FAQ: Posterity not responsible for customer failure to meet standards of operation
- Standards of use FAQ required
- Refund policy: unspent years refunded ONLY if company closes OR delivery proves unfeasible AND customer met required standards
- Tax compliance (Phase 6)
- Service time limit legal documentation (5yr guaranteed, unlimited optional) — lawyer input needed
- Formal escrow language — lawyer review Phase 6
- Lawyer input required before Phase 5 financial build begins

Marketing

- Core angle: life chapters not dates
- Hero line: "Your voice. Forever."
- Supporting line: "Your legacy, on your terms"
- The four plan phases are a core brand differentiator and selling point. Phase language removes all clinical or death-related terminology from the product entirely and should be prominent in marketing materials, the onboarding walkthrough, and the user dashboard.
- January 1 delivery start is a marketing and trust-building point — Posterity is thoughtful about when content is delivered, not just that it is delivered. Content lands when recipients are ready to receive it, not in the immediate fog of grief.
- Upgrade savings story: more messages/videos = lower cost per unit
 - Premium saves 24.5% vs Basic rate
 - Legacy saves 28.3% vs Basic rate
- Sales sheet + investor growth projections + break-even by user numbers (Phase 6)
- Testimonials section: user videos, text, accolades, articles — build after accruing content (Phase 6)
- Life insurance company partnership (post-launch opportunity)
- Gauge social media platform interest and expand beyond Facebook/Instagram as demand grows

Design Phase (Phase 6)

- App appearance fine-tuning
- Logo design
- Claude design first, Canva as backup

Potential Late Add-Ons (Tabled — not concrete)

- Application/approval process for all users
- Additional social media platforms
- Trusted contact payment authority
- Facebook Memories feature
- Trusted contact handling payments after passing

Tech Stack

Tool	Purpose
Next.js	App framework
Tailwind CSS	Styling
Supabase	Database + Auth
Stripe	Payments
Vercel	Hosting
GitHub	Code storage
Cursor	AI-assisted code editor
Buffer	Social media posting (admin side, post plan activation)
Twilio	Phone number + voicemail + SMS/MMS
FFmpeg.wasm	Video compression (Phase 4)
Meta Business API	Facebook/Instagram (Phase 4/5)
Mercury Bank	Business banking + automated transfers (Phase 5)

Project Location

- Local: C:\Users\jerth\posterity
- GitHub: <https://github.com/jerthwicked/posterity> (PRIVATE)
- Live URL: <https://posterity-seven.vercel.app>

What's Been Built

- Development environment (Node.js v24, Git, Cursor)
- Next.js project, Homepage, Login, Signup, Dashboard, Pricing pages
- Working Supabase authentication (email/password, confirmation OFF)
- PWA installed on Android
- Live on Vercel
- MCP servers in Cursor: GitHub MCP (26 tools) + Supabase MCP
- Cursor shell allowlist: npm, node, git, npx auto-approved
- Stripe sandbox account, 4 products created
- Pricing page with all 6 tiers, Stripe checkout working and tested
- Global nav in layout.js (dropdown, all pages)
- Homepage cards matching pricing cards
- sync-context.js + npm run sync for end-of-session context updates
- Project Documents folder created in project root
- Cursor Pro subscribed (Sonnet 4.6 for daily use, Opus 4.8 for complex tasks)

Environment Variables

Set in both .env.local and Vercel:

- NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL
- NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY

- SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY
- NEXT_PUBLIC_STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY
- STRIPE_SECRET_KEY
- NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=<https://posterity-seven.vercel.app>

MCP Setup

- Config: C:\Users\jerth\posterity.cursor\mcp.json (in .gitignore)
- GitHub MCP: personal access token, no expiration
- Supabase MCP: personal access token (sbp_...)
- Stripe MCP: to be added when Stripe goes live

Session Workflow

- Brainstorm and plan in Claude.ai
- Claude.ai writes prompts for Cursor Agent (Sonnet 4.6)
- Cursor Agent writes and pushes all code
- End of session: paste "Update CONTEXT_for_posterity.md with everything we worked on this session, then run npm run sync to copy it to Documents and regenerate the PDF, then commit and push everything to GitHub with an appropriate commit message" into Cursor Agent
- g = go/approved, d = done

Stripe Products (PENDING PRICE UPDATE)

Product	Current Price ID (outdated)	Status
Posterity Horizon	price_1Tcvq1BcdnR2VoDgYustrs4G	No change needed
Posterity Basic	price_1TeTeyBcdnR2VoDgYhf7uym0	Pending update to \$99
Posterity Premium	price_1Tcvj2BcdnR2VoDgt4oZu8VA	Pending update to \$249
Posterity Legacy	price_1TeTj5BcdnR2VoDgtfA9O3z8	Pending update to \$899

New Price IDs to be generated when Stripe is updated. Update codebase and Vercel env vars after each change. Always test checkout after updating.

Important Links

- Live site: <https://posterity-seven.vercel.app>
- GitHub: <https://github.com/jerthwicked/posterity> (PRIVATE)
- Vercel dashboard: <https://vercel.com/jerthwicked/posterity>
- Stripe dashboard: <https://dashboard.stripe.com/test/dashboard>
- Supabase dashboard: <https://supabase.com/dashboard/project/vpytftmutmeyfwmkapjg>
- Pricing analysis PDF: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1nnJhh0fyng8HbgPDchzJMzb5v-MCqJE/view?usp=sharing>

Phase Roadmap

Phase 3 (Current) — 2-3 sessions (4-9 hours)

- Update Stripe prices to locked pricing (\$99/\$249/\$899) + update Price IDs in code
- Update codebase and Vercel env vars after each Stripe change, always test checkout after updating
- Add Limited Availability tag to Legacy plan card

- Legacy customer cap: 10 customers, configurable from admin dashboard
- Rename Financial Hardship to Grace on pricing card, update description
- Connect Stripe to Supabase (record subscription on payment)
- Horizon subscription transition logic (transitions into initiated plan upon payment)
- Webhook for subscription status changes
- Lock dashboard behind subscription tiers
- Trusted Contact portal page + separate login + nav dropdown entry

Phase 4 — 8-12 sessions (16-36 hours)

- User profiles (real-date calendar setup, content scheduling, social media setup)
- Multi-plan dashboard with side menu (create and work on multiple plans simultaneously)
- All plans in Horizon auto-included in cart at initiation
- Onboarding walkthrough + AI chatbot + test/preview mode
- Four plan phases explanation in onboarding and dashboard
- Check-in system (6 month intervals, 3 month warning, 2x/month notifications via Twilio + email)
- Trusted contact system (optional portal, double verification confirmation, invitation flow)
- Video upload + FFmpeg.wasm compression (client-side at upload)
- Video size/length validation (25MB max, 720p min, 3-4 min max)
- Remaining messages/videos ticker
- Video rollover to messages
- Multi-year cart system with storage fee calculation
- Meta Business API + Buffer integration
- Per-customer backup credentials (required, Posterity-generated, 2FA via Posterity-controlled contact)

Phase 5 — 6-8 sessions (12-24 hours)

- Admin/operational dashboard (priority task list)
- Separate financial dashboard
- Mercury Bank two-account setup (Trust Account + Operating Account)
- Automated year-by-year fund release via server-side cron job
- Admin dashboard alerts for automation failures
- Manual input panel for Build Your Own and Grace accounts
- Manual override for API failures (Post Manually button)
- Simultaneous post processing
- Via Twilio: voicemail + outbound SMS notifications
- Posterity email account
- Audit logs for all financial movements
- Test account option
- Lawyer review before financial build begins

Phase 6 — 4-6 sessions (8-18 hours)

- App appearance fine-tuning + logo design (Claude first, Canva backup)
- Tax compliance
- Terms of Service + lawyer review + copyright application
- Liability FAQ + Standards of use FAQ
- Refund policy finalization
- Formal escrow language review
- Testimonials section (after accruing content)
- Sales sheet + investor materials + growth projections
- Life insurance partnership exploration
- Service time limit legal documentation

Total Remaining: 20-29 sessions (40-87 hours)

How To Resume

1. Open Cursor
2. Open terminal (Ctrl + backtick)
3. cd posterity
4. npm run dev
5. Open <http://localhost:3000>
6. End of session: npm run sync then commit and push

Developer Notes

- Windows 11, PowerShell (no && between commands)
- Node.js v24.16.0, non-technical founder, all code by AI
- Owner: jerthwicked (GitHub)
- g = go/approved, d = done
- File creation: use \$content = '@' ... then [System.IO.File]::WriteAllText() to avoid UTF-8 corruption